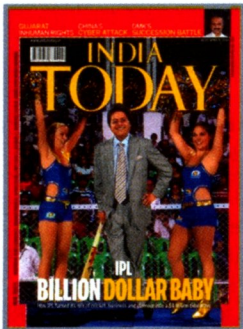


Billion Dollar Baby

APRIL 5, 2010

A brand value that has more than doubled to \$4.13 billion and two new teams that cost about as much as the eight of 2008. The IPL now rivals top corporate houses.



“The Indian Premier League (IPL) has proved that India actually has no dearth of money underneath. All one needs is an appropriate spade to dig it out from the pockets of those at the helm of affairs.”

RAJNEESH BATRA, *Delhi*

The Great Game

The showbiz IPL has grown beyond our imagination (“Billion Dollar Baby”, April 5). Its astronomical success has made not only Lalit Modi proud, but also glued everyone together for business and entertainment. While we cheerfully embrace IPL or cricket in general, other sports can also survive parallel to it, if invigorated carefully. Can cricket be a bellwether for sports like hockey and soccer? Ventures like the IPL can make it possible. It would be ecstatic to gain our lost glory in hockey and enrich our identity in other sports as well.

SANJIV GUPTA, *Perth, Australia*

It was only last year that the second season of the IPL was on the brink of being called off after it tried to take on the might of the



The Siege Within

It looks as though some of the leaders of the militant groups do not want any quick settlement (“No Table Manners”, April 5). They should see the writing on the wall and give up their tall objectives of setting independent states within the Union. Moreover, these breakaway groups should demonstrate their popular support by taking part in the elections to prove their point.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Positive talks are a wonderful solution to end a stalemate. No talks with any militant group can succeed unless both parties are honest and want a solution to the vexed issues. To hold and buy time for regrouping or quelling the militants doesn't yield results.

V.K. TANGRI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Government of India. Exactly a year later, not only is the mega cricket event back with a bang but is also looking set to expand its horizons. At a time when austerity is the mantra on everyone's lips, the recent purchase of two new franchises—Pune and Kochi—exemplifies the vibrancy of the IPL's business model as well as its immunity to recession.

MEGHANA A., *Hyderabad*

The IPL has transformed cricket in all departments of the game. It has ceased to be a gentleman's game. That cricket players should be put on the auction bloc and pocket lakhs isn't acceptable. The organisers must be made to pay a hefty amount to the government for taking security measures and equally heavy income tax

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301.

Phones: 2479900 from Noida, 95120-2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad, and 0120-2479900 from Rest of India.

Toll Free No.: 1800 1800 100. Fax: 0120-4078080. E-mail: wecare@intoday.com